

A Praise Called 'The Omniscient Great Lord'

Sarvajñamahāśvarastotranāma · Toh 1111 · Derge Tengyur

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Toh 1111 in the Tengyur is a devotional hymn in Sanskrit and Tibetan known as the Sarvajñamahāśvarastotranāma, or in Tibetan, Thams cad mkhyen pa dbang phyug, rendered into English as "A Praise Called 'The Omniscient Great Lord.'" It is a stotra, a verse hymn of praise, celebrating a supremely enlightened lord who transcends the gods, serves as the ultimate guru, and has burned away the triple world of desire and confusion through the radiance of wisdom — imagery that evokes both Buddhist and Indic devotional traditions. The text honors this omniscient great lord through a series of reverential stanzas, each culminating in an act of homage or refuge, reflecting the classical Indian genre of laudatory verse addressed to a transcendent figure. Notably, no Indian commentary for the text was found, and the work was completed at the glorious monastery of Sakya by the Śākya monk Kunga Gyaltsen Palzangpo, placing its Tibetan transmission firmly within the Sakya scholarly tradition.

Not having found an Indian commentary for it, the text was later completed at the glorious monastery of Sakya by the monk of the Śākya order known as Kunga Gyaltsen Palzangpo. Thus it is finished.

In the language of India: Sarvajñamahāśvarastotranāma. In the Tibetan language: A Praise Called "The Omniscient Great Lord."

Homage to the Three Jewels.

He who is a god surpassing the gods,
he who is the guru of the gods,
he who has become the guru of gurus —
to him I go for refuge.

Greatness itself and lordship itself,
he who has become the supremely great lord,
the lord liberated from the three worlds —
to that lord I bow in this very life.

By the radiance of wisdom-fire,
the triple city of the nature of desire and bewilderment
is utterly burned to ash —
to that burner of the triple city I bow.

He who always bears the skull of loving-kindness,
anointed perfectly with the ashes of compassion,
adorned on his head with the moon of moral discipline —
to that lord I bow in this very life.

Mounted on the supreme vehicle of the Great Vehicle,
possessed of the supreme horn of loving-kindness and compassion,
the eye of joy and equanimity —
that great lord who thus proceeds:

Accompanied by the retinue of consorts such as
the supreme ones of generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence,
meditative concentration, and the rest,
to that great lord who thus proceeds I bow.

Pervading all with the horn of deception,
shattering from all sides the existence of affliction,
the unbearable progeny of the far-going existence,
the great blazing burner of fiercely burning views,

Who holds in mind whatever charnel grounds require,
whose form is manifested in many varied guises,
always embraced by an assembled retinue —
to that great lord I bow.

Surrounded by the objects of desire of the three worlds,
he whose retinue is the destroyer of those who seek their aim,
he whom none who executes his command can reach —
to that great lord I bow.

Possessed of eight-limbed discipline,
born from the egg of the feet of miraculous power,
the great island of fearlessness that surrounds on all sides,
whose gate itself moves and is supremely pure,

Through whom flows the water of compassion,
who holds the river of the sacred Dharma —
to that great lord I bow.

The buffalo of ignorance
that terrifies the entire world —
he who skewers it with the three-pointed tip of wisdom,
that three-pointed great lord:

All states — highest, lowest, and those between,
pacified or unpackified —
he who liberates all the unpackified completely —
to that great lord I bow.

He who, by the excellence of supreme compassion,
clearly removes all the sufferings of birth without remainder —
to that remover I bow with reverence.

Supremely excellent and glorious lord,
who has abandoned craving for the waters of desire —
to you I bow, O Great God (Śiva).

He who brings happiness to all sentient beings,

He who, by following after all,
gathers all sentient beings —
whom the obstacles of māra cannot overcome,
the destroyer of desire — to him I bow.

He who is supremely the great lord himself,
the person who opens what is deeply corrupt —
to you I bow, O Great God,
who intend benefit for all sentient beings,

Who has become the universal enemy of harm,
who by loving-kindness uproots attachment,
who fully perfects the white virtues —
to that lord I bow in this very life.

Beings afflicted by planetary forces and epidemic disease, poverty,
and beings tormented by karma —
he who pacifies them swiftly by mere speech,
to that pacifier I bow.

By the merit I have gathered
through praising the lord of all the world,
may this entire world without remainder
become the great lord of wisdom.

The Praise Called "The Omniscient Great Lord" was composed by the brahmin
layman Mātṛceta. It is complete.

It was translated by the Indian paṇḍita Jārandhana and the great translator
Rinchen Zangpo.

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens with a colophon stating that, an Indian commentary not being available, the monk Kunga Gyaltsen Palzangpo completed the work at Sakya monastery; this appears to be a colophon to a preceding commentary text, not to the praise itself.

The Sanskrit title in the text reads "Sarvajñamahāśvarastotranāma," meaning "A Praise of the Omniscient Great Lord," identifying the subject as Maheśvara (Śiva) viewed through a Buddhist lens — praised here as a deity liberated from the three worlds and endowed with compassion and wisdom, following a genre of Buddhist polemical or syncretic eulogy.

The composer is identified as the brahmin layman Mātṛceta, a renowned early Indian Buddhist poet. The translator Rinchen Zangpo (958–1055) is the celebrated Tibetan lotsāwa of the early translation period.

The phrase rendered "the buffalo of ignorance" is a reference to the deity Maheśvara's mythological role as slayer of the buffalo-demon Mahiṣa, here reinterpreted as the destruction of the buffalo of ignorance — a standard Buddhist rereading of Śaiva imagery.

The "triple city" burned by wisdom-fire alludes to the myth of Tripura, the three demonic cities destroyed by Śiva, here reread as the destruction of the triple city of afflictive existence through gnosis.

The lines on "pacified or unpackified" reflect a Tibetan expression distinguishing beings in nirvāṇa from those still in saṃsāra; the rendering attempts to preserve the doctrinal contrast between those who have attained cessation and those who have not.